

# Bendamustine: Belrapzo, Bendeka, Treanda, Vivimusta

**Original Effective Date:** 12/5/2022

**Revision Date(s):** 12/5/2022; 11/7/2023; 4/25/2024; 9/24/2024; 11/4/2024; 10/1/2025

**Review Date:** 10/1/2025

**Policy type:** Medical Necessity

**Line of Business:** All GEHA Medical Plans

Authorizations are issued for 6 (six) months, unless the ordering physician requests a different timespan or the patients' unique circumstance or condition supports the medical necessity for a different authorization timeframe. Reauthorization requests are reviewed for efficacy, safety and tolerability.

| Preference    | Requires Prior Auth | Drug Name                                | HCPCS Code   | Description                                                          |
|---------------|---------------------|------------------------------------------|--------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Preferred     | Yes                 | <b>Treanda</b>                           | <b>J9033</b> | Injection, bendamustine hydrochloride, 1 mg                          |
| Preferred     | Yes                 | <b>Bendamustine 505(b)(2) Dr Reddy's</b> | <b>J9999</b> | Not otherwise classified, antineoplastic drugs                       |
| Non-preferred | Yes                 | <b>Bendeka</b>                           | <b>J9034</b> | Injection, bendamustine hcl (Bendeka), 1 mg                          |
| Non-preferred | Yes                 | <b>Belrapzo</b>                          | <b>J9036</b> | Injection, bendamustine hydrochloride, (Belrapzo/bendamustine), 1 mg |
| Non-Preferred | Yes                 | <b>Vivimusta</b>                         | <b>J9056</b> | Injection, bendamustine hydrochloride (Vivimusta), 1 mg              |

- Members must have documentation of a contraindication, failure, or intolerance to any of the preferred agents (or their 505(b)(2) equivalents) prior to approval of a non-preferred product, when clinically appropriate.
- Preferred product requirements apply to all requests, both new and reauthorizations.
- Step Therapy applies to all overlapping compendia supported indications/regimens.

## Universal Approval Criteria:

Unless otherwise noted, the review criteria used by OncoHealth to determine medical necessity for anticancer treatments and supportive agents include, but is not limited to:

- National Comprehensive Cancer Network® (NCCN) - use consistent with NCCN recommendations carrying a Category 1 or 2A level of evidence; **OR**
- United States Food and Drug Administration (FDA) labeling - new drugs or regimens (combinations of drugs) consistent with the product labeling; **OR**
- Indications not included in the official FDA labeling or recommended by NCCN (Category 1 or 2A level of evidence) may be considered if determined to be medically necessary per one or more of the following compendia:
  - Clinical Pharmacology (Strong For); **OR**
  - Wolters Kluwer Lexi-Drugs® (Level A); **OR**